```
Output:
int(1)
int(1)
int(1)
```

The first valid delimiter character encountered in the pattern (ignoring any leading whitespace) becomes that pattern's delimiter and must be used to finish the pattern, and it must also be escaped (with a backslash character) if used as a literal character. Here's what I meant about switching delimiters if the delimiter itself is a common character in the pattern:

```
$text = 'http://www.iloveregex.com/';
var_dump(preg_match('/http:\/\/www/', $text));
var_dump(preg_match('#http://www#', $text));
```

```
Output:
int(1)
int(1)
```

Modifiers

Characters placed after the final delimiter of a pattern are evaluated as modifiers and control the behavior of the regex engine. The available modifiers are

Table 8-24. *PCRE regex modifiers*

Modifier	Effect
i	Case-insensitive match
m	Multiline match
s	Control behaviour of the . metacharacter
u	Enable Unicode property matching
x	Whitespace in pattern has no significance
A	Pattern is "anchored" to start of sample text
D	Control behaviour of the $ metacharacter
U	Control "greediness" of quantifiers